

Neighborhood icon and select Properties. Click on Add, select Client and add Client for Microsoft Networks. From the File and Print Sharing option, enable it.

3. For DCC, you can work with the NetBEUI or IPX/SPX protocol. Just install one of these protocols from the Network properties (Add Protocol). If you are adding TCP/IP you will need to assign an IP



You have to be a host or guest for DCC

address. Add the Dial-up Adaptor also from the Add Adaptor option.

4. Connect the null-modem cable to the COM ports.

5. Share a directory or folder on the computer. Start DCC from Start >

Programs > Accessories > Direct Cable Connection. You have the option of connecting as a host or a client. The problem could lie here because the client can see all the shared folders on the host, but the reverse is not possible.

If you get the verifying username and password option, it means there is no problem with the ports or the cable. Also, ensure that when you log on Windows during startup you haven't hit the Cancel button.

Hardware + Display on DOS

I have an Intel Pentium II 400 MHz PC with 256 MB SDRAM. Recently, I installed a SiS 6326 display adapter card. It works fine with Windows GUI environment but while booting or working in DOS, it generates dots at random positions in the display. Sometimes some letters of the alphabet even start blinking. What could be the problem?

K Thiyagarajan,
Via e-mail

R This problem could be related to the memory on your newly installed graphics card.

Try or borrow a spare display card to test whether this behaviour recurs. If it does, it could be a problem with the AGP bus, in which case you will have to try testing with a different motherboard.

Hardware + Power effects

I have an assembled P-III 800 on Mercury 815e motherboard and a 28.5 Seagate B with 128 MB RAM. My problem is that whenever I switch on the system the power lamp and HDD activity indicator glow continuously, but the system doesn't boot. If I leave it like that, sometimes it boots after a few minutes, and this could take anywhere from less than a minute to 10 minutes. Please shed some light.

Gurpreet,
Via e-mail

R There are two distinct possibilities here. This could be a problem with your power supply wherein it is not supplying clean power to the motherboard to get it running.

Try changing your power supply or borrow one from your vendor and test it out. Alternately, you can try reversing the jumper on your motherboard for the ATX power switch. This could solve the problem. Remember to discharge yourself of all static electricity before you open up your PC. You can do this by touching the non-powder coated parts of your metal cabinet with your bare hands.

Applications + Multiple burns

I received Nero Burn 5.0 CD with my CD-writer, and as I have three CD-writers (Plextor). I downloaded Nero 5.5 from the Net so that I can write using multi-recording facility, i.e. be able to write on three writers at the same time with same source. But I am unable to do so. I have tried to select two writers in Nero 5.5, but have been unsuccessful. What should I do to use multi-recorder writers?

Aniruddha Dikhit,
Via e-mail

R Nero 5.5 per se doesn't allow you to burn more than one CD-writer at the same time. But the special edition of the software (for which you have to pay) allows you to simultaneously record to 32 CD-writers. Another software you can work with is Easy CD Creator Platinum edition.

Alternatively, if you have your CD-writers installed on separate IDE controllers then you could try running two separate CD-writing software. Of course, your PC

Hardware + Battery issues

My system's CMOS battery becomes weak repeatedly and I am losing the system time and date. Earlier, I had no problems with my system battery. But then I upgraded the PC with another motherboard (Tomato with AMD K-6 processor) and within two to three months the system battery started failing. I have changed it twice but it's of no use. Please help me out.

Rohit,
Via e-mail

R Most likely, you may have received a faulty battery with your new motherboard. Besides, CMOS batteries have a problem with the relatively high humidity present during the rains. These batteries generally last for two to three years, although some (especially the lithium type) have been known to last much

longer. Ironically, the less you use your computer, the faster the CMOS battery will run out. This is because when your computer is turned off the battery begins to function. So, for starters try keeping your computer in a non-humid environment, and if that doesn't work, it's likely that you have a defective motherboard and you will have to replace it.

